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Strategic Fit

What is the business context underlying this feature?

MISSION

To elevate the quality of life for urban consumers by offering unparalleled convenience.

VISION

To be India's most loved consumer internet brand powering seamless access to food, groceries, and daily essentials.

COMPANY STRATEGY

First platform in India with verified allergy safety difficult to replicate

PRODUCT STRATEGY

Captures 8-12% allergic segment (4-5M potential users)

TEAM GOALS

Establishes audit framework for future safety initiatives (hygiene ratings, freshness guarantees, etc.)

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User Value

What's our initial hypothesis on user profile, problem and goals?

User Profile Hypothesis

DEMOGRAPHIC / FIRMOGRAPHIC

Our primary users are urban working professionals aged 25-40, earning ₹8-25 LPA, living in metro and Tier-1 cities. They are predominantly college-educated individuals working in tech, consulting, healthcare, or corporate roles. Approximately 60% are female, reflecting higher health consciousness in food ordering behavior. The segment includes singles living independently, young couples, and parents with young children who have severe food allergies. These users are health-conscious, risk-averse regarding food safety, and willing to pay a premium for trustworthy, transparent food options.

PRODUCT BEHAVIOURS & USAGE PATTERNS

These users currently order 1-2 times per week on Swiggy, significantly below the platform average of 2.8 times per week, primarily due to anxiety around food safety. They spend 15-20 minutes browsing before placing an order (compared to 8 minutes platform average), during which they obsessively read reviews, search for terms like "nut free" or "gluten free," and check menu descriptions for allergen information. They demonstrate extremely high restaurant loyalty, with 70% of orders going to the same 2-3 "trusted" restaurants, limiting their discovery of new options. Their cart abandonment rate is 35% versus the

18% platform average, often abandoning at checkout due to last-minute safety concerns. They heavily utilize the special instructions field with notes like "NO NUTS – severe allergy" and frequently add phone numbers requesting restaurants to call them. They are 3x more likely to contact customer support before or after orders and maintain personal "safe restaurant" lists outside the app in Notes or spreadsheets.

User Problem Hypothesis

PROBLEM AREA

The core friction occurs across four critical phases of the ordering journey. In the pre-order decision phase, users cannot verify if restaurants understand allergy severity, menu descriptions lack detailed ingredient lists, and the "allergy info" field is blank 80% of the time, creating paralyzing fear when considering new restaurants. During order placement, special instructions feel unreliable with no confirmation that restaurants have acknowledged allergy requests or will follow customizations. In the post-order waiting phase, users experience anxiety while waiting for delivery with no transparency into food preparation practices. Finally, in the post-consumption phase, if

SIGNALS

The problem is validated through multiple strong signals across user feedback, behavioral data, and medical context. Play Store reviews show ~15,000-20,000 negative reviews in the past two years mentioning allergies, with users stating "Clearly mentioned NO PEANUTS in special instructions. Got peanut sauce. Had allergic reaction. Swiggy did nothing. Never ordering again" and "The 'allergy info' section is ALWAYS empty. How am I supposed to know if it's safe?"

SEVERITY

This is a CRITICAL, life-threatening problem with severe impact across multiple dimensions. Physical safety severity is maximum – allergic reactions can cause hospitalization, anaphylaxis requiring emergency epinephrine, and in extreme cases, death, with medical costs ranging from ₹20,000 to ₹2 lakhs per incident. Emotional severity is very high – users experience constant anxiety, fear, and stress around every meal order, with ~20-30% of allergic users having experienced anaphylaxis and carrying EpiPens daily. Time cost is medium-high – users spend an extra 15-20 minutes per order researching, calling restaurants, and second-guessing

an allergic reaction occurs, there is no accountability or recourse, leading to permanent loss of platform trust and trauma that prevents all future ordering.

decisions. Trust erosion severity is very high — a single negative incident results in permanent platform abandonment, with most never returning

USERS IMPACTED

Based on Swiggy's approximately 20 million monthly active users and medical prevalence data showing 8-12% of urban populations have food allergies, we estimate 1.6-2.4 million existing Swiggy users are impacted.

ALTERNATIVES

Users currently employ six primary workarounds, all of which are inadequate. 45% call restaurants before ordering, but this has only 30% success rate due to disconnected calls, staff who don't know ingredients, language barriers, and time consumption

User Goals Hypothesis

QUALITATIVE

Users express their desired reality improvement through emotional, functional, and social dimensions. Emotionally, they want to "order food without fear of getting sick," "trust that the restaurant understands how serious my allergy is," and "feel peace of mind that cross-contamination won't happen." They want to "feel normal — like everyone else who just orders food easily" rather than being burdened by special needs every time.

QUANTITATIVE

User success will be measurable through behavioral shifts and self-reported metrics. We expect post-order anxiety scores to drop from 7/10 to below 2/10 as measured through in-app surveys. Trust metrics should show 75%+ of users agreeing "I trust Swiggy with my allergy" in post-feature surveys.

NON-GOALS

This feature explicitly does not provide medical advice, diagnose allergies, or replace EpiPens and emergency medical care, and we cannot guarantee 100% zero-risk, requiring clear legal disclaimers. We are not attempting to cover every possible allergen



Key Stakeholders

DECISION MAKERS

The VP of Consumer Products serves as the primary decision maker, evaluating this feature against portfolio priorities including profitability improvement, retention metrics, and competitive positioning—approval hinges on demonstrating clear ROI within 6 months and alignment with FY25 premium user growth mandate. The Head of Trust & Safety acts as co-decision maker given the legal liability implications, requiring robust audit frameworks, insurance coverage, and zero-incident track record in pilot before scaling—this stakeholder will veto if risk mitigation isn't bulletproof.

INFORMED

The Restaurant Partnerships Team must be informed early as they will execute certification outreach, manage restaurant onboarding, negotiate audit cost subsidies, and handle partner concerns about compliance burden—they need 8-week advance notice to prepare scripts and pilot 50 Bangalore restaurants. The Legal & Compliance Team requires continuous updates on liability disclaimers, FSSAI partnership terms, data privacy for health information (user allergy profiles), and insurance policy structuring to protect Swiggy from lawsuits if reactions still occur despite certification.

The Marketing & Communications Team needs visibility to craft "India's first allergy-safe food platform" positioning, prepare PR strategy for launch, develop educational content explaining certification process, and manage crisis communication protocols if incidents occur.

The Customer Support Team requires training materials on handling allergy-related queries, escalation protocols for adverse reactions, and updated macros explaining badge meaning—they'll face 3-4x spike in allergy questions post-launch.

The Engineering & Data Science Teams need roadmap visibility for building certification management systems, badge display infrastructure, user profile features, and analytics dashboards tracking feature performance.

The Product Marketing Team must coordinate in-app messaging, push notification campaigns targeting health-conscious users, and A/B tests

on badge design to maximize trust perception and click-through rates.

Business Goals Hypotheses

QUALITATIVE

This feature transforms Swiggy from a transactional marketplace into a trusted safety platform, creating a defensible moat that competitors cannot replicate without 12-18 months of infrastructure buildout and partnership establishment. It repositions Swiggy in the premium health-conscious segment, attracting affluent users who currently view food delivery as convenient but unsafe, thereby reducing price sensitivity and discount dependency that erodes margins.

QUANTITATIVE

We project 200K monthly active allergic users by Month 12 generating ₹109 crore annual GMV and ₹16.4 crore platform revenue, achieving 16x ROI on ₹1 crore investment with Month 4-5 break-even. Order frequency among allergic users will increase 67-100% (from 1.5 to 2.5-3x/week), while 30-day retention improves from 45% to 65-70% and 6-month LTV increases 40% (₹3,500 to ₹4,900). Cart abandonment will drop from 35% to 15-18%, recovering ₹8-12 crore annualized GMV, and certified restaurants will grow from 50 to 500, experiencing 20-35% order volume lift. Support ticket volume will decrease 40-50% for allergy queries, saving ₹15-20 lakhs annually, while NPS increases from 30 to 55 and market share capture brings 30K-50K competitive wins worth ₹18-25 crore GMV.

NON-GOALS

We are not targeting mass-market volume—this is a high-LTV niche play, not attempting to become the highest-GMV feature in Year 1. We're not building a standalone app or separate brand, not subsidizing certification costs beyond 6 months, and not guaranteeing zero allergic reactions legally. This does not replace core discovery or deprioritize non-certified restaurants, does not target lifestyle diets (only medical allergies), and will not expand beyond 5 cities in Year 1. We're not creating a parallel regulatory body or competing with FSSAI, and not marketing through expensive celebrity endorsements—acquisition stays organic and digital-focused under ₹100